Prepare For Trouble, And Make It Double.

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41022117.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma & Scorpia (She-Ra), Catra/Double Trouble (She-Ra), Catra & Double Trouble (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
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Part 7 of Catradora Smutshots

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by vagician

Summary

It's been a while since the war ended and while Etheria had healed from it's scars, Catra finds herself struggling to do the same. Never one fond of healthy coping mechanisms, Catra turns to the one person who can imitate the person she craves in her hour of need. Double-Trouble. But that moment of weakness comes with a price, one with a high risk that ends up being a high reward.

Or: Catra assumes Adora and Scorpia are now a thing and she relies on a certain shapeshifter to stay with her for a night and shift into the one person she's convinced herself she'll never be worthy of.

Or x2: Adora walks in on Catra in bed with her clone, and after an awkward confrontation, something amazing ensues.

(Oh and there's some minor filler of Glimmer and Adora both playing wingman to coach Scorpia on how to get closer with Perfuma so yeah, there's that to look forward to too lol.)

Notes

Not my best work but hopefully someone will enjoy it.

Note:So the only thing that's changed from canon is the kiss and love confession at the end of season five since I wanted to do my own take on it. Feedback is always appreciated and I'm open to requests depending on the scenario. Anyway, I've rambled on for long enough. Enjoy!

"Alright, honey. Since you're a new client let me lay down some ground rules before we get down to the fun stuff." Double-Trouble announced, the shifter posted on the edge of the vanity dresser. They had their palms laying flat on the edge of the desk with one of their legs crossed over the other, each lithe limb rocking an impressive set of thigh highs. For a moment Catra glimpsed the shifter drop the insufferable grandstanding, their tone shifting to a more serious one.

"Half of the payment upfront, and the rest once you're good and taken care of. Kissing and aftercare will cost you extra, though with a bed this luscious, I just might be open to a discount." they continued, eyeing the formidable mattress that Catra deemed the biggest eyesore out of this over-decorated room. She loathed it because she knew she didn't deserve any of the luxuries in these quarters. *Her* quarters. The ones Glimmer had so graciously given her after Catra finally left the Horde behind her.

It felt wrong to make a home in the very kingdom she was set on bringing ruin to so many times before. In the very palace formerly ruled by the queen Catra had indirectly killed when she had to be a monumental dumbass and go opening that fucking portal. With the amount of blood on her hands, she would often ask herself why she was even here at all, even when a part of her already knew that answer.

Catra would never be caught admitting it out loud, but at the end of the day, she was here for Adora. Everything was for Adora. The center of her universe and the honorable descendant of the First Ones who just so happened to be hopelessly loved by the most undeserving individual of them all. Catra herself.

But of course the blonde warrior had no way of knowing that, and she never would if the feline had anything to say about it. Catra had shut the woman out so effectively that it shoved her into the arms of another entirely. The same individual who also happened to have the title of being another added victim to the aftermath of Catra's wrath. Scorpia.

It had to be cruel irony that the two women in this world who wanted nothing more than to get closer to her would end up finding solace in each other. Adora swore tooth and nail that nothing was going on between them but why else would they be getting so close to each other all of a sudden? The two had become more attached at the hip than she and Catra were as kids, essentially becoming inseparable. That blooming connection ended up progressing to the point where Scorpia even became the fourth official member of the best friend's squad. A title that would have been given to Catra had she not made it a point to shut out that act of kindness as well.

Catra couldn't even be mad at the pincered princess, since the woman didn't have one mean bone in her body, nor would she ever think to do something like this purely out of spite. She didn't even know the true extent of Catra's feelings for Adora so how was she to know that growing bond with her childhood friend was wounding Catra so severely? The woman was simply trying to find her place in this world, and Catra couldn't condemn her for that.

If anyone deserved a happy ending it was Scorpia for having to take on all the unneeded manipulation and emotional trauma she had tolerated from the hybrid, obliviously mislabeling the abusive dynamic between them as friendship since it was all the princess had ever known.

It was just another good thing Catra's emotional unavailability had somehow managed to tarnish along the way, even when the clawed princess had no ulterior motives other than simply wanting to be her friend.

As agonizing as it was, Catra could sadly see why the two princesses were so drawn to each other. Much like Scorpia, Adora was a beacon of light to all of Etheria, and Catra felt like her mere presence alone would be enough to taint the purity and nobility the warrior princess embodied.

She had no right claiming to love Adora in the way that she did, since her past actions towards the warrior were the furthest thing from love one could get. Why Adora chose to continue putting up with her shit at all was an anomaly Catra would never be able to wrap her head around.

What had her the most frustrated was Adora had forgiven her without any hesitation or pause, as if the violent history they had on their roster hadn't taken place between them at all. Catra knew all too well the extent of torment she's put the blonde through, her only parting gift for the woman being scars that not only spanned the emotional barrier, but physical too.

How the hell could Adora forgive her when Catra couldn't even find it in her to forgive herself? She didn't want kindness. She didn't want good fortune, nor prosperity. She wanted someone to tear what was left of her apart and hate her as much as she hated herself. If fate intended on surrounding her with nothing but allies, then Catra would just have to become her own worst

enemy and take on the punishment her peers refused to give her. And in this moment of weakness, that self-loathing was becoming a punishment in itself.

This probably had to be an entirely new category of low even for her. Never did she think she would be calling up a shapeshifter and paying out of pocket for them to manifest the love interest even her dreams weren't worthy of being in the presence of. Yet here she was, her nagging loneliness adamant on making an even bigger fool out of herself while draining her wallet in the process.

The feline knew there was a special place in hell for people like her, but Catra had absolutely no fucks to spare and had nothing left of value to lose, her dignity included. If this was the closest thing to happiness she could fabricate within her misery, then she was going to take what little of it she could get.

Catra exhaled a defeated sigh, reaching into her coin purse while trying to ignore the approving hum she heard sound from the shifter. The feline counted half of the payment out in her palm before begrudgingly dropping the bits of gold into Double-Trouble's outstretched hand. The chameleon seemed set on counting the payment out twice for good measure before a sly smirk etched itself into their lips, the shifter appearing satisfied with the math.

"Oh, how I've missed my little cash kitten. You know Catra, you've had me infiltrate a lot of places in our days together, I just never imagined one of those places would be *you*. Not that I'm complaining, mind you. I always did like them feisty." Double-Trouble quipped, hopping off the dresser with a flip of their hair.

Catra glowered in response, the hybrid in no mood for their excessive theatrics.

"Cut the crap, will you? I'm not paying you to have an opinion. I'm paying you to get me off." Catra reminded them, settling with an animated roll of her eyes when the chameleon let out a dry chuckle, circling the feline like a predator would their prey.

"Touchy, aren't we? And here I thought we could play a little game of cat and mouse, but have it your way, sweetness. So what can I do for the mighty Catra this evening? Shall we continue as is or was there someone else you were hoping would rock your world tonight?" Double-Trouble pondered in mock interest, circling until they were right behind the feline, their breath ghosting her ear. "Perhaps a certain little blonde bimbo who's always giving you those big doe eyes whenever she thinks you aren't looking?"

Catra had never been very good at managing her temper, but something within her snapped at the audacious insult, her low growl shifting into an infuriated roar. The feline whirled around to face the shifter, grabbing the chameleon by the throat before brutally slamming them back into the wall.

"Insult her again. I fucking *dare* you." Catra snarled at them, the chameleon's amused expression threatening to trigger the feline all over again. Even when Catra's claws pressed into their pulse point, Double-Trouble didn't appear in the least bit phased, the shifter continuing to remain aloof.

"Careful, kitten. You'll damage the goods if you keep that up." the chameleon teased, soon taking on the form of the very person this heated encounter happened to be centered around. When Catra blinked it was no longer Double-Trouble's neck she was squeezing, but a smirking Adora. "And we wouldn't want that, now would we Catra?" the clone continued, grabbing onto the feline's wrist when her grip around their throat slackened some, gently prying her hand away.

Catra stared at the substituted form of the woman that would always remain emotionally out of her reach, unable to muster any more malice now that it was Adora she was looking at. A smart move on the shifter's part, since Catra had been two seconds away from tearing their throat out and the foul tongue it happened to be attached to. She refused to let her shame torment her any more than it already has.

The remorse would inevitably come later, all she had to do was focus on not thinking at all. Don't think, just be. Adora and the rest of the do-gooders she associated with would be due back at the palace this evening, which meant Catra only had a short window to exercise these inner demons looming over her in silence. And maybe, just maybe, she could find a moment of peace in this personal hell of hers, if even only for a night.

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"Are you *sure* this is going to work? Perfuma already knows how to make flowers bloom.. I don't see how me giving her more of them is going to help." Scorpia said with a troubled frown, her pincers carefully relieving Adora of the bouquet of sunflowers in

her outstretched hand with a grinning Glimmer at her side. The three princesses were posted just outside Bright Moon's garden, tactfully hiding behind one of the hedges as the trio continued to watch the floral princess contently humming to herself in the gazebo. Ever since Shadow Weaver departed from this world, the garden had become Perfuma's own personal sanctuary, spending most of her visits peacefully tending and nurturing the plants that resided here. Glimmer went to pat the fellow princess's shoulder but with her lack of height, it resulted in the queen patting her lower back instead.

"It's not about the flowers, Scorpia. It's about the meaning *behind* them. Sure she could make an entire garden bloom if she really wanted to, but receiving something she cherishes so much from someone else would mean *so* much more to her! Just *trust* me on this, okay?" Glimmer reassured her as Adora nodded in agreement.

"Do you remember what we went over in the flashcards? Now is your last chance to peek at them. And whatever you do, *don't* read them in front of her." Adora added, handing over the pile of flashcards that had pointers and various ice breakers the pincered princess could fall back on to help steer the conversation if need be.

"I remember! Or, at least I think I do. *Crap*.. What were we talking about again?" Scorpia babbled nervously, prompting Glimmer to facepalm herself in the background while Adora gave her a sympathetic grin.

"Well, I'm just gonna leave these here *just* in case." Adora answered, slipping the flashcards into Scorpia's pocket before

Glimmer gave her a friendly nudge forward. Scorpia took an anxious peek around the hedge, about to head over to the gazebo when she suddenly paused, uncertainty in her expression as she glanced back at the two.

"Something wrong?" Adora asked, able to empathize somewhat considering she had a certain feline she was sweet on as well. The only difference was where Adora's case felt like a lost cause, she had high hopes for Scorpia and Perfuma. The devotion and loyalty Perfuma displayed when Scorpia was being controlled by Horde Prime was a prime example of just how much the flower princess cared for her, refusing to hurt her even when Perfuma's safety was on the line.

"No, it's just.. I've never had anyone care enough about me to coach me like this.. I don't think I'd be able to do this if it weren't for you both.." Scorpia admitted, using the pincer that wasn't holding the bouquet to scratch the back of her neck nervously.

"That's what the best friend squad does! We're *always* looking out for each other. Now, worry about thanking us later and get your butt *over* there!" Glimmer politely ordered, walking over to give her another insistent nudge.

"Right.. *Okay*, Scorpia. You *got* this.." Scorpia reassured herself, clearing her throat before finally emerging from behind the hedge. The two princesses watched as she awkwardly neared the gazebo, the bouquet of flowers tactfully hidden behind her back as she approached the flower princess.

"H-Hi, Perfuma!" Scorpia stumbled over her friendly greeting, her stomach in knots as Perfuma gradually turned to face her. Even from their vantage point from the bush, Adora could plainly see how much Perfuma's expression lit up at the sight of the fellow princess. It was a bittersweet feeling for Adora. While she was happy to provide Scorpia some closure, it just made her think about her own hopeless situation, knowing the one person she yearned to get closer to, would never be able to reciprocate the depths of those feelings.

"Oh, Scorpia! I was just thinking about you!" Perfuma beamed at her, her elated grin spanning the entirety of her face. Scorpia blinked, once to try and rid herself of the puzzled look she wore and then twice for good measure.

"You *were*?" she asked, unable to hide the surprise in her tone. Adora and Glimmer giggled from their hidden vantage point, the queen of Bright Moon murmuring something along the lines of "*Ah, young love!*" under her breath.

"Of *course* I was, silly! Come on, I want to show you something!" Perfuma insisted, excitedly grabbing one of her claws as she hurriedly towed the princess behind her.

"Darn it, I can't hear them from here." Glimmer complained as she watched them disappear into the greenhouse. Adora felt her wrist get grabbed by the queen, a startled noise exiting the princess of power when both she and Glimmer momentarily blinked out of existence, the pair soon rematerializing in one of the more secluded areas of the greenhouse. The sizeable sacks of sod and bags of various plant food positioned around them gave them just enough cover to remain hidden as the pair crouched

down low, Glimmer taking a cautious peek around one of the stacks of soil. Perfuma led Scorpia to one of the planters lined up against the glass wall, several sunbeams cascading through the crystal panes to illuminate just about the most beautiful bed of roses Adora's ever seen.

"Aren't they beautiful?" Perfuma exclaimed, the floral enthusiast leaning down to one of the bushes, a blissful sigh leaving her as she took in a generous whiff of air.

"They're lovely, Perfuma! I'd say they're almost as beautiful as you are." Scorpia blurted her thoughts aloud, too entranced by the environment to acknowledge the words she'd let slip. Adora and Glimmer threw each other a look.

"I don't remember writing *that* on any of the flashcards.. I think she conjured up that one herself. *Well* played, Scorpia." Glimmer commented with pride, casting a sideways glare when Adora nudged her head out of the way to lean out and sneak a peek for herself.

"With game like that, I'd say we aren't needed here anymore." Adora deduced with a smile, giving Glimmer a curious look when a minor snort left the queen.

"*Too* bad, we're staying anyway. I'm too invested in this to leave it on a cliffhanger. We've come this far, we're seeing it through to the *end*, damnit. And besides, I already know Bow is going to nag me later for details and I don't want to come back to him empty-handed." Glimmer reasoned in a hushed whisper. Adora smiled

and rolled her eyes, bringing her attention back to the lovebirds they were snooping on. Perfuma turned with wide eyes, the light tint to her cheeks matching the bed of roses behind her.

"You think I'm beautiful?" she asked, disbelief embedded in her words. Scorpia looked like a deer caught in the headlights, her embarrassment leaving her with a blush at a much deeper tint.

"Crap, did I say that out *loud*? Oh, geeze.. I uh.. Wow, did it get warm in here? Heh, today's been a scorcher!" Scorpia stammered mindlessly, tripping over her own words as a nervous bead of sweat departed from her hairline. Glimmer sighed to herself in the distance, half of a grimace taking over. "So much for game.." she muttered quietly.

"*Oh*, I almost forgot!" Scorpia exclaimed, revealing the bouquet of sunflowers she had hidden behind her, her claw trembling around the fragile bundle as she cautiously offered them to her. "These are for you." she finished.

Perfuma gasped, her face lighting up brighter than the rays of afternoon sunlight beaming down on them both. She gratefully accepted the bouquet, a delighted little squeal exiting her as she twirled in place, bringing the flowers up to her nose. Scorpia's face was still plenty flushed, but it had simmered down to a lighter pink, indicating she was now more flustered than she was embarrassed.

"Thank you, Scorpia! Sunflowers are one of my absolute favorites! How did you know?!" Perfuma asked, carefully setting the

bouquet aside to free up her hands. Before Scorpia could answer she felt herself getting pulled into a bear hug, the flower princess conveying the extent of her gratitude as she squeezed her tightly.

"Uh, to be honest, I didn't.. *Heh*, guess it was just a lucky coincidence! I just saw them and they made me think of you. The sun is always brightening up the day for everyone else and you're always brightening up the day for me so sunflowers seemed like the perfect fit cause y'know, the sun and *all*." Scorpia admitted, happily returning the hug on her end.

"How can she go from awkward to smooth so effortlessly? *Ugh*, I swear that woman is an anomaly." Glimmer lowly tutted as they continued to eavesdrop on the pair. Perfuma pulled back from the embrace, but kept her arms looped around Scorpia's neck. The two gazed at each other and for a minute, and Adora was starting to feel guilty for snooping in on such an intimate moment. Meanwhile, Glimmer seemed transfixed, a quiet "Come on, kiss already!" being muttered from the shorter princess. Scorpia eventually frowned, her insecurities coming to the surface.

"What's wrong? Oh stars, there's something on my face isn't there?" Scorpia questioned, disengaging an arm from around her to wipe her cheek as best as she could manage with oversized pincers. Perfuma giggled at the display, her reassuring smile putting Scorpia at ease.

"*No*, silly! It's just.. Nobody's ever said something so nice to me before.." Perfuma brought one of her hands upward, giving Scorpia's left cheek a gentle caress while granting a delicate kiss to the right. "Thank you, Scorpia. I feel the same way whenever I'm around you." Perfuma murmured against her cheek.

The moment would have been a success if it weren't for Glimmer forgetting they were supposed to be keeping a low profile. An excited "*Yes*!" left the queen as she jumped in the air and out of cover, doing a triumphant fist pump. Both Scorpia and Perfuma shrieked in unison at the interruption, the startled jump Scorpia made resulting in some of the flashcards unknowingly falling from her pocket.

"Goodness, what are you two doing here? And Adora, why are you crouching like that? Did you lose something in here?" Perfuma asked, the index cards on the floor grabbing her attention. Adora awkwardly sprang upward back to her feet, an apologetic grin shaping her lips.

"Who, me? *No* ! I *uh*.. I.. I was just tying my shoe! *Yeah*, my shoe. *Heh*. You know those pesky laces, always coming undone and whatnot." she nervously rambled, prompting Glimmer to jab her side with her elbow to get her to shut up before her mouth could dig herself an even deeper hole to fall in.

"I must be missing something. I don't see any laces on your shoes.. Are you sure you're alright, Adora? You're giving off a very tense vibe right now." Perfuma asked as she knelt down to pick the cards up from off the floor, the three other princesses giving each other a hopeless expression of panic when Perfuma looked them over, appearing perplexed.

"What's all *this*? And what's an icebreaker? That sounds awfully violent." Perfuma stated as Glimmer scrambled for an answer, the queen feeling obligated for fixing the mess her big mouth started.

"They're flashcards! Scorpia was holding them for Adora. She's planning to use them on Catra." Glimmer took her first excuse and rolled with it, causing Adora's cheeks to turn redder than Scorpia's pincers.

"I'm *what*?!-"

"Oh my gosh, really?! You two are finally going to get together?! It's about time! I'm so happy for you, Adora! And you're helping her, Scorpia? That's *so* sweet of you.." Perfuma beamed, but Scorpia had a remorseful grimace on her face, shaking her head in a no.

"Just stop it you two. As embarrassing as it is, I don't feel right lying to her." Scorpia answered, a defeated sigh leaving her when she looked at the smile falling away from Perfuma's face, confusion taking over.

"Lie to me? I don't understand.."

"Those flashcards aren't Adora's.. They're mine.. I just wanted to get to know you better and I didn't want you to think I'm boring so they were giving me a few pointers.. I'm sorry, Perfuma. You must think I'm an idiot.." Scorpia's shoulders slumped in defeat, stubbornly staring at the ground in mild shame.

"I could never think something so mean about you, Scorpia." Perfuma started, looking over the cards with half a smile as realization slowly set. "You went through all of this just for *me*?" Perfuma asked, the delight in her voice causing Scorpia to risk a glance upward.

"Well, yeah.. I just.. I *really* like spending time with you and.. I don't know, sometimes I wonder if maybe we can be *more* than friends.. *Gah*, I know it sounds lame, but-" Scorpia stopped short when Perfuma brought her index finger to her lips to gently shush her. When Scorpia ceased talking, Perfuma took both sides of her face in her grip, the flower princess standing on her tippy toes to give her a chaste kiss on the lips. Adora and Glimmer shared the same moronic grin with each other as they watched the display of affection, grateful they were able to salvage their plan after all. Scorpia blinked in a stupor when their lips finally parted from each other, the kiss leaving her with a dazed smile.

" *I* -.. wow.." she whispered, causing them both to exchange a coy giggle with one another. Perfuma made a flicking motion with her wrist, causing a flower to bloom right above Scorpia's ear, the petals matching the tint of her blush as the vine gently looped around the shell of it.

"Well, I think we've invaded enough of your privacy for one day. It's about time Glimmer and I hit the ole dusty trail. Have fun you two!" Adora announced with a nervous laugh, looping her arm around the queen's before attempting to haul the protesting princess away from the area.

"*Wait*, we were just getting to the good-"

"We're *leaving*, Glimmer. Stop being a creep, will you?" Adora ordered as she dragged a grumbling Glimmer behind her. Once they were safely back out in the courtyard, Adora's marching slowed to a walk, letting go of her arm before breathing a relieved sigh.

"Well, that went surprisingly well considering the events.." Glimmer broke the silence, ignoring the eye roll the princess of power served her.

"It would have gone *better* if you had just kept your mouth shut. Way to blow our cover, Glimmer." Adora chided her, despite wearing a smile of her own.

"What can I *say*? I'm in love with seeing love! And *speaking* of which.." she started, stopping in front of the blonde to narrow her eyes in playful suspicion. Adora sighed, already knowing where this line of questioning was headed.

"Not *this* again, Glimmer. We've been over this. Catra wants nothing to do with me. And why would she? I couldn't save her from anyone. Not Shadow Weaver, not the Horde.. Not even herself." Adora mumbled, the topic of discussion unearthing memories she wished would remain buried.

"But you *did* save her, Adora. She's here with us now because of *your* actions. *All* of us are here because of you. You didn't just

save the world, you saved a universe full of people!" Glimmer insisted, her praise going on deaf ears.

"I left her in that hell, Glimmer. Before I was She-Ra, I was supposed to be her friend. And I couldn't even manage *that*. A friend would have gotten through to her, not left her behind to start anew." Adora answered, the bottom of her eyes swimming in a fresh layer of tears. Glimmer grasped her shoulder, trying to get her to look at her.

"Adora, there was *nothing* you could have done differently. You can't help someone unwilling to receive help themselves. She had to figure that out and go on her own path. It might have taken longer than you would have liked to get her back in your life but the important thing is she's here *now* . And I'm sure she needs you just as much as you need her. Just *talk* to her. *Be* there for her." Glimmer advised her, causing the blonde to serve her an exasperated look.

"I've been doing that and it's gotten me nowhere. She insists on shutting me out anytime I try getting close to her." Adora stubbornly argued, absently glancing up at the window on the palace that held the room the feline was residing in, leaving her with a pained frown.

"Because she expects you to leave again. You need to prove to her that that isn't the case. Just wait it out, Adora. It may not seem like you're getting anywhere but patience is key in these types of situations. Be the person she needed all those years ago. Show her that she *can* move on from this. That *you* can move on from this." Glimmer continued, a gratified grin shaping when her words seemed to get through to some distant part of Adora.

"I guess it wouldn't hurt to try." Adora narrowly agreed, huffing when Glimmer let out an excited squeal.

"That's the spirit! Now go on, we've been gone all weekend. I'm sure she misses you by now." Glimmer gave her a friendly shove forward before the princess dematerialized altogether, leaving Adora with nothing but her thoughts to sit with. She doubted any part of Catra would miss her absence as much as Glimmer insisted, but the thought was nice to think about. Adora let her thoughts continue to centralize around the feline as she roamed the palace, her heart rate increasing when she finally reached the door to Catra's quarters. She reached for the handle but a muffled voice behind the door had her pausing.

"Tell me you love me.." a voice sounded from afar, Adora's heart sinking into the lowest pit of her stomach when she identified it as Catra's. Adora nearly stormed away but morbid curiosity had her halting when she heard the additional voice, and the eerie familiarity to it.

"Pillow talk costs extra, kitten." the familiar voice answered, the pet name ticking a nerve within the blonde. Since when has Catra let *anyone* call her kitten? Adora brought her ear to the door when she heard a frustrated growl.

"Alright, whatever! Just add it to the damn bill and get a move on for fuck sake!" Catra yelled, making a strained noise Adora's never heard come out from her before. She had enough to put together what was taking place on the other side of that door, but what was the whole bill thing about? Adora had more questions than

she did answers at this rate. Adora scowled at the approving hum that followed, the mystery individual cutesying up their voice.

"I love you, Catra." they cooed, though it was clear there was no emotion whatsoever in the response. Adora felt a heat pooling just beneath her navel at the moan it earned from the feline, mortified with her own perverted snooping. This was wrong. She shouldn't be here doing this. Whatever Catra was doing back there, obviously wasn't supposed to be meant for Adora's ears. Tears welling in her eyes, she forced herself to turn around, about halfway through with leaving the area before one simple word had her halting dead in her tracks.

"A-Adora.."

Was Catra calling out to *her*? There was no way, right? Catra didn't even know she'd returned yet, but why else would the feline have her name in her mouth?

"Aww, Kitten. You must *really* have it bad for her, don't you?" the additional voice teased as Adora brought her ear back to the door, justifying the eavesdropping by insisting to herself that since her name happened to be involved, it indirectly made it her business as well. Adora felt many emotions stirring within her, the majority of them conflicting with each other.

The first being bewilderment at the fact they were talking about *her* in that bedroom, jealousy being the second from the revelation Catra was opening up to a stranger when Adora's been breaking her back ten times over just to maintain some sort of

connection with her, and utter confusion at the entire nature of their conversation. But there was one more emotion that kept bubbling up to the surface for the princess, a feeling as foul as it was potent for the blonde. It was angered curiosity, and Adora felt herself giving in.

She gripped the knob of the door, glaring downward to see that it was locked. That was hardly a hindrance with the volatile emotional state Adora was dealing with right now. Hell, they could have gotten rid of the door altogether and even that wouldn't have stopped her. She'd plow through every obstacle obstructing her from getting the answers she needed. Now that she mastered her connection with She-Ra's essence, calling upon the form had become second nature to her, to the point where she didn't even need to rely on uttering the honorary chant to summon the transformation anymore.

Adora felt every minuscule cell in her body begin to vibrate in preparation for the transformation as the princess gradually ascended into the air, her irises bursting a luminous blue before her aura flared around her, the luminous flash of energy blanketing her body with a golden white hue. The princess felt her perspective of the door shift when her body began to grow higher, slimmer limbs now bulking out in size to maintain a form equipped for handling such a raw increase of power. The strands of her hair began to lengthen as well, the golden locks continuously pulling tauter until they grew to their limit, the formidable ponytail now ending just past the small of her back.

Those vibrations increased as her outfit morphed along with her, a part of her always wondering where her original clothes had disappeared to when she was in this state. Her educated guess would have her saying magical purgatory but then again, what did

she know? All she knew was this form would provide her the strength and intimidation needed to get some damn answers to all the open-ended questions festering in her head right now. When the transformation was complete the magic had her floating downward, her feet reconnecting with the floor once more. Using her boot to take the brunt of the impact, She-Ra essentially turned her body into a battering ram, kicking the door straight off its hinges.

———

Catra screeched like she was being murdered, the sudden noise startling her from the legs her head was previously buried between, certain she would have jumped high enough in the air to reach low-etheria orbit had it not been for the roof of her room halting the launch. Her fur bristled instinctively at the threat of the intrusion, her tail inflating several sizes in alarm. Her immediate impulse was to whirl around and bare her fangs. Which to her credit, she did, but the hiss she howled out died in her throat when she saw the real Adora no, *She-Ra* standing right where the door used to be, the splintered remnants of the thing scattered around her boots. Had Catra not been so mortified by the situation, she would have found the brutal force of strength incredibly hot.

"Oh, I always did fancy a juicy plot twist. Let me guess, you wanna take it over from here, don't you sweetheart?" Double-Trouble cooed at her, a wave of insurmountable embarrassment hitting Catra when She-Ra's fierce gaze changed to one of bewilderment when her eyes locked to the form of her naked clone. Double-Trouble made an animated stretch of their body as

a satisfied sigh left them, lifting themselves off the mattress before the chameleon shifted back to their original form, seemingly unphased by the entire encounter.

"Leave us. *Now*." She-Ra sternly ordered, the warrior's voice deepened to a much more commanding maturity that always leaked out whenever the princess of power ascended to this state of being. Catra didn't say a word, her face burying her shame into the pillow she was hugging, as if closing her eyes tightly enough would somehow make this entire situation go away.

"Oh, I'd be happy to accommodate that request. As soon as my cash kitten finishes paying me for my services." Double-Trouble announced, making Catra snort under all that humiliation at the revelation the money-hungry shifter dared to request payment at a time like this. She-Ra took a step forward, the sheer intimidation of her presence having the chameleon take an unknowing step backwards, traces of fear surfacing in their expression once their back greeted the wall, realizing they've been cornered.

"Your first mistake was assuming it was a request. Your second mistake is thinking you have a choice in the matter at all. Would you like to know what your third mistake is going to be?" She-Ra rhetorically asked, fisting the top of the chameleon's outfit, effortlessly picking them up without any effort needing to be expended at all.

"Heh, on second thought, why don't you just keep the change. It's clear I'm not needed here anymore." Double-Trouble stammered, exhaling a sigh of relief when the warrior's grip slackened, setting the shifter back on the ground. Double-Trouble cautiously navigated around the princess before taking off like a bandit,

eager to get as far away from this interaction as possible. Catra wished to do the same but the level of embarrassment she was working with left her unable to do anything but cling to the comfort of her pillow, stubbornly avoiding the fierce set of eyes boring into the side of her head in silent judgment.

"Catra.."

The silence continued.

"Catra, *look* at me."

She couldn't, even if she wanted to.

The feline heard the warrior exhale a sigh, the retreating footsteps suggesting Adora had given up and left her to wallow in her own misery but after a moment the footsteps ceased, the blonde staring back at the hiding feline with angered determination.

"You know *what*? No. You *don't* get to do this to me. Not anymore. I've tried playing nice, but it's getting me absolutely nowhere with you. So this is what's going to happen. You're going to tell me what the hell that was about, and I'm not leaving this room until I'm satisfied with your answer. And don't try and say it's none of my business, because bringing a clone of me into it *made* it my business." She-Ra declared, grabbing the feline's discarded shirt on the floor before impatiently chucking it at her.

It was then that Catra was reminded of her partial nudity, squeezing her eyes shut to deny the tears that wanted to flow as she weakly reached for her shirt, mustering up enough will to slowly pull it over her shoulders. Her ears flattened in the midst of her shame, continuing to have a staring match with the bed so she didn't have to look at her.

"Won't your pincered girlfriend miss you?" Catra childishly muttered out, the taint of her jealousy already starting to reveal itself. A displeased growl emanated in her throat when the princess of power laughed at her in disbelief, making Catra assume it was at her expense.

"I'm sorry, my *what*?" She-Ra questioned, reacting as if Catra was speaking to her in a foreign dialect. That she had the audacity to try and play dumb about the whole situation ticked just about every nerve in existence for the hybrid, her defensive anger finally having her head snap up to address the princess directly.

"Don't you even try and go playing dumb. You've been hanging out with her way more than you've ever bothered with me. I *know* there's something between you two. I'm not an idiot, Adora." Catra snapped back, her building irritation having the tip of her tail lashing two and fro.

"Catra, the *only* thing between Scorpia and I is Perfuma." Adora snickered out her answer, finding the feline's surfacing jealousy a little endearing.

"*See*, I *knew*- wait, what?" Catra stopped short, no part of that sentence making any sense to her. She-Ra's expression softened to the point where the transformation demanifested altogether, the frustrating dork of a princess she's grown to love reappearing in her place.

"Scorpia came to Glimmer and me for advice on how to get closer to Perfuma so we've been coaching her on what to do. That's the only reason we've been hanging out as much as we have." Adora explained, her anger all but gone as she braved her way over to the bed, taking up a seat on the edge of it. Catra's cheeks blazed with a blush, unable to decide whether she was more relieved or embarrassed over the miscommunication.

"So you two have been playing wingman for her this *entire* time?" Catra skeptically questioned, her tail curling around itself as she hugged her knees to her chest.

"That's pretty much the gist of it, yes. I figured if I focused on helping her improve her love life it'd help distract me from my own. Or, *lack* of, rather." Adora nervously admitted, She-Ra's confidence departing with the form as the blonde anxiously fumbled with her hands in her lap. After a moment Adora finally addressed the major elephant still lingering in the room. "So all of this was because you were jealous?"

"Oh, *screw* you. I am *not* jealous!" Catra yelled at her, instinct having her automatically deny the accusation despite the validity of it.

"You know, I'd be more inclined to believe that if I didn't just witness you going down on a clone of me." teased the blonde, her expression one of smug amusement. Catra had never been more grateful for her layer of fur than in this moment, since it was the only barrier concealing the magnitude of blush the crude statement invoked in her. But unbeknownst to Catra, Adora had indeed sensed the change in her demeanor, sporting a sly grin as she continued to prod.

"It's just funny, you know? I mean if you're the one paying, wouldn't it make more sense to have the clone of me going down on *you*? I think you got the short end of the stick here, Kitten." Adora quipped, the term of endearment barely leaving her before an approving purr emanated out of the feline, much to her dismay.

"Are we *really* doing this right now?" Catra groaned her complaint, her nose wrinkling in annoyance when she sensed the grin in her peripheral vision grow from slight to insufferable.

"I believe we are." Adora countered, slyly moving closer to the hybrid as she playfully bumped shoulders with her. Catra bit the inside of her cheek, highly aware of the dwindling proximity between them.

"Don't you think I've been put through enough humiliation for one day?" Catra muttered, warding off the urge to smile at her ridiculousness. Adora frowned in return.

"Is it really that much of an embarrassment for you to admit you're attracted to me?" Adora asked, her deflated tone birthing a sliver of guilt within the feline.

"Would you really be surprised if I said yes?" Catra grumbled, squeezing her pillow tighter while redirecting her glare onto the floor.

"I guess not.." Adora agreed with a huff, curious determination having her switch up her tactic. Catra was just within her reach, opening up more to her now than she's ever had in the past. Adora decided to take that leap and roll with it, gently placing a hand on the hybrid's leg.

"Would it help if I said the feeling was mutual?" Adora inquired, voice as weak as a whisper. Catra peeked down at the hand on her knee, the simple gesture sending tidal waves of emotion crashing straight at her center. Catra couldn't help but smirk.

"Liar." she accused, a minor snicker ringing through her when Adora scoffed in defense.

"Am *not*!" she insisted, taking her hand off her knee to give her a friendly shove to the side. Audibly laughing now, Catra leaned back over to give her the same shove.

"Are *too*!" the feline continued through her laughter, moving to shove her again but this time around Adora wasn't going down

without a fight, dragging the feline on top of her as they both went plummeting into the mattress, nothing but a mess of giggles between the two of them. The laughter subsided when Catra realized she was now hovered over the blonde, close enough to share a breath between them. Catra had never seen Adora so flustered before, the light tint to her cheeks a look on her Catra could get used to seeing, especially when she put together she was the reason the princess was so flustered. Blue eyes locked on with their mismatched counterpart, neither of them willing to say a peep in the fear it would break the spell between them, and cause all of this to disappear.

"Catra?" Adora let the back of her knuckles graze along her cheekbone, the gesture intentionally affectionate.

"Yeah?" she asked, her tone as gentle as the blonde's embrace.

"I really want to kiss you right now." Adora shyly admitted, the statement almost sounding like a warning rather than an admission. Catra grinned from ear to pointed ear.

"Then why don't you?" Catra wondered aloud, eyes dropping down to the view of her partially parted lips. Adora went stiff beneath her.

"Because if I start, I don't think I'm going to be able to stop.." Adora whispered, the promise in those words having the hybrid stifle a shiver, the mutual want between them growing thick enough to be palpable. Catra propped her forehead against the

blonde's, their noses greeting for an Eskimo kiss, merely inches separating their lips from the contact they craved.

"Then *don't* stop, princess." Catra murmured back, the both of them hanging in emotional limbo for a moment before something changed in Adora's expression, her eyes harboring a hunger Catra's never witnessed in her before. They both decided to close the distance at the same time, lips clumsily colliding with each other as a startled gruff left them both. The brief gasp from Adora was all the reassurance Catra needed to know she made the right decision, kissing the blonde below her like a woman with a purpose. Bodies pressed snugly against the other, the sinful heat growing between them only rapidly accumulating like kerosene flirting with fire.

Catra didn't have much time to process the mind-numbing anomaly taking place. The last remaining functional brain cell left in her head could only chant "*I'm actually kissing Adora*" on a continuous loop, the revelation feeling too good to be true even as it actively played out in front of her. *Adora* was kissing her. Not a clone, not the Adora she could only fabricate in her dreams, but the *real* Adora. A pang of guilt had her impulsively wanting to deny herself the happiness she felt seeping through her being, but the magicat couldn't muster up the energy to do anything other than continue to lose herself to the woman below her.

Catra's lips parted in a gasp when Adora's arms looped around her, nails trailing down her sides until they settled at the hem of her shirt, bunching it up just enough to bare the small of her back. It was as if Adora knew the area was a sweet spot to the magicat, the tips of her fingers biting into her skin as she teased the sensitive area just above the base of her tail. The moan that

followed had Catra breaking off the kiss, arching her back as a wide-eyed Adora stared up at her in awe.

"What *now*, punk?" Catra questioned, using humor to deflect the vulnerability she was feeling right now. Adora grinned moronically, and Catra couldn't decide whether that goofy look on her was stupidly attractive, or stupidly stupid. The steady thrum of her heart against her ribs eventually had her deciding it was the first.

"It's just.. This is so much better than I imagined it would be.. I feel like I'm dreaming right now." Adora confessed, hands navigating to her hips when Catra retreated back to straddling her lap. After taking a moment to come to terms with the monumental news that Adora had actually fantasized about doing this as well, Catra amusedly cocked a brow at her, shaping a self-satisfied smirk before she gave the blonde's side a firm pinch.

"*Oww*, what the hell was that for?!" Adora shrieked as she twisted away from her unsuccessfully, shooting the feline a glare when Catra started to lightly snicker.

"Did that hurt?" asked the hybrid, her smirk increasing right along with the intensity of Adora's scowl.

"Of *course* it hurt, genius." Adora muttered back, rubbing the light ache the pinch left in her side. Catra bent downward, catching her lips in another kiss much gentler than anything they've shared before.

"Then you *aren't* dreaming, dummy." Catra informed her, Adora's snort getting buried against her lips, a moan emerging in its place when Catra slipped her knee between the apex of Adora's thighs, shifting forward to apply a calculated amount of pressure to the area. A gasp flew out of the blonde's lungs when she finally gained some purchase against it, inhaling sharply as the back of her head crashed into the mattress. The hybrid paused to look down in awe, still struggling to come to terms with the fact she was the one plucking these condemning noises out of Adora. It was nearly tempting enough to just drop the facade and give her what she wanted right then and there, but Catra held onto that last string of patience like her life depended on it, wanting to drag this out for as long as she was able.

If she wanted, she could summon up a lie and insist she was taking her time since she wanted to savor every little minuscule event taking place in this moment, but that would only be a fraction of the truth. The entirety of the truth was Catra's growing fear that she wouldn't get it right. She's only ever done this with herself and escorts from the various brothels at the Crimson Waste, and all of those encounters had been a paid service with the luxury of having no strings attached, But *this*? With Adora of *all* people? It came with all the strings, the majority of them being strings Catra wasn't sure she was ready for just yet. Two battle-ridden hands delicately cusping her face tethered the worrying feline back to the present moment.

"Hey, come back to me." Adora murmured, scratching that one tender tuft of fur right at the base of her ears, giggling triumphantly when it managed to get the magicat purring again.

"I'm *right* here, you dork." Catra's cheek smushed into her hand, nuzzling into it approvingly at the needed display of affection.

Adora continued to pet her, pushing a stray lock of hair behind her ear, tucking it out of sight.

"You may be here but I can tell your head's somewhere else. I just.. I don't want this pushing you away even further.. I-I *can't* lose you-.." Adora trailed off as if the rest of the sentence would physically pain her, her voice on the verge of breaking. Past Catra would have been cruel enough to exploit that brief show of vulnerability, while future Catra… Well, she didn't really know what future Catra would do since that was always subject to change, but *present* Catra? All she wanted to do was take the blonde's worries and shoulder them herself, just so Adora didn't have to anymore. As much as she dreaded the thought, she knew the only way to get close to achieving that would be to open up herself. Open up less desired parts of herself she's made a life out of closing.

"Hey, cut that shit. You couldn't get rid of me even if you wanted to, princess. You're sorta stuck with me now, I hope you know that." Catra booped her nose with her tail, delighted to see Adora didn't swat it away this time. Even with the dorky smile on her face, Adora was the epitome of perfection. She had a light behind her eyes that shined brighter than all the primal magic on Etheria, and Catra couldn't help but think how lucky she was that even after all this time, Adora never gave up on her.

"You promise?" the princess asked, reaching up to wipe away a stray tear departing Catra's cheek, the feline unaware that she'd been crying until now.

"I promise." Catra vowed, their lips almost connecting again when something Adora murmured made her pause at the last minute.

"Tell me you love me."

" *I* -.. What?" Catra stammered, despite hearing Adora's words with perfect clarity. Even with her clothes still on, Catra suddenly felt exposed, the fur at her spine prickling out in alarm.

"That's what I heard you saying through the door.. You know, before I kicked it off it's hinges and what not.." Adora trailed off, appearing as nervous as Catra presently felt.

" *Oh*.." was all the hybrid managed to say.

"Yeah.." Adora started, before starting to break out into one of her signature rambles, the ones that only came out when she was buckled under enough stress. "I'm sorry, Catra.. I shouldn't have been listening.. I know it was a private moment and I wanted to walk away but then I heard you say my name and it made me stop and all these thoughts just started flooding into my head about what it could mean.. I kept telling myself surely I must have been sleep-deprived and just hearing things I wanted to hear, but then I started to wonder if there was actually a part of you that loved me too, and that's what made me barge in here.." Adora blurted out, but there was only one single word in that jumbled mess that really grabbed the feline's attention.

"*Too*? You mean.." Catra didn't finish the sentence, refusing to let her mind go there. It was a want buried so deep within her that she never did anything but repeatedly deny its existence, knowing

it was pointless to fantasize about a happy ending that would never come to fruition. Or so she *thought*.

"I love you, Catra. I always have and I don't think I've ever stoppe- *Oof*!" Adora had the wind knocked out of her when Catra's lips came crashing back down to hers, hoping the exchange would convey everything the hybrid was too scared to put into words. The only other time she felt this happy was saving the universe from Prime's control, and even that impossible feat couldn't shine a candle to the pure sense of belonging she felt now. Catra couldn't help herself. Purring with the force of a motor, she begrudgingly ended the kiss, pulling back to stare at her with wide eyes.

"Say it again." the feline requested, fangs worrying her lip as she awaited her answer, and the unprecedented amount of joy she'd receive from hearing it again. Catra groaned internally when the blonde smugly raised a brow, knowing there was going to be a witty retort flying out of Adora's mouth any second now.

"Not until you say it back." Adora countered, determined to pry Catra's repressed feelings out of her one way or another. The hybrid's cheeks warmed, never once thinking of voicing those words into existence until now. Adora's face faltered when Catra hesitated, self-doubt beginning to steal away the smile Adora held. "I mean, if you want to.. I don't want to push you into anything you don't want to-"

"Do you even have to ask? Of *course* I love you, you idiot." Catra began, nudging her head to the side with her own. "*My* idiot." she finished, further illustrating her point by nuzzling into her neck, allowing her scent to claim the blonde.

"I can't tell whether I'm being complimented or insulted right now." Adora said with a pout, but the elated grin she wore betrayed the extent of her happiness. Catra hummed right along with her purr, the princess tensing with a bite of her lip when Catra curved a smirk against her neck, lips resting right at her pulse point.

"Can't it be *both*?" the feline quipped, pressing her firm into the mattress with her knee, the toned limb never leaving the sensitive region it ended up in earlier. With a hitch of her breath. Adora's nails anchored into the hybrid's hips for something to hold. Catra assumed it was a silent plea to stop but then she felt the blonde hoist her hips closer, encouraging her to grind down harder. Somewhere in the blissful chaos, Adora's thigh slipped between her own, lifting at just enough of a slant to provide the feline her own smidgen of relief. The magicat still had her boy shorts on but the fabric was flimsy enough to hardly be a hindrance to her pleasure, a possessive growl rumbling in her sternum as she ground her hips down harder, in a frantic pursuit for friction

And while Catra got lost in chasing that promise of relief, the knee against her center was the catalyst for Adora achieving her own. Each rock of hips had the blonde spewing utter nonsense, each half-formed vocalization getting interjected with a series of grunts. It was by all means risky considering Catra's room didn't exactly have the privacy of a door anymore, but the feline hardly cared. High risks always brought high rewards and the high she was riding now felt incomparable to anything she's experienced on this planet or the next.

Their movements were predictably inexperienced, but they managed to find a rhythm that worked for them, each return trip of hips allowing their bodies to get to know each other a little better. Adora's hands sneaking beneath the hem of Catra's shirt earned her a whine of desperation that only grew in intensity when her grip ascended up to her breasts, thumbing both hills of flesh into a stiffened peak. Between all of the overwhelming stimuli and the way Adora was looking up at her like she was the only thing in this world that mattered, Catra felt her resolve start to shatter right along with the pressure at her center, that need splintering into a tinier mess of shards piercing through her being.

Her climax hit her like an avalanche. Silent at first but no less destructive as it tore her to pieces in the best sort of ways. She yowled out a moan that ended in Adora's name, repeating it like a prayer that would somehow keep her tied to the perfection of this moment. There were several minutes of uninterrupted bliss before Catra acknowledged the screams and pleas ricocheting off the walls weren't just her own. Somehow seeing Catra fall apart on top of her was enough to send Adora hurdling over the edge right along with her.

The tempo of their hips calmed to a mere simmer as they shepherded each other through the aftershocks, only ceasing to a standstill when the overstimulation became too much to bear. Catra went to disengage her knee from the warmth between her legs but a hissing Adora stopped her, clenching to the limb for dear life.

"Not *ah* -.. yet.. Still sensitive.." she mumbled, an embarrassed blush surfacing on her cheeks. That embarrassment got wiped into irrelevancy when Catra bent down to kiss her cheek, deliberately avoiding her lips to allow the warrior some downtime

to retrieve the air that had been stolen out of them both. But Adora wasn't having it, turning her head at the last minute so their lips would meet instead, grinning into the kiss when she felt the tickle of a tail curling around her wrist.

"Did we just.." Adora couldn't bring herself to finish the sentence, but luckily she didn't need to. A rather smug feline was all too willing to finish it for her.

"We *did*. And it won't be the last time either if I have anything to say about it." Catra purred, veering her lips down the side of her jaw to press a gentle kiss to her throat. The hybrid frowned when she felt Adora go rigid, looking up to check in on her. She almost thought the statement had been too possessive when she saw the humiliated look in her expression, but after a moment to decipher the change in demeanor, Catra realized Adora wasn't looking at her. She was looking *behind* her.

Catra had a hunch on what summoned that horrified look on Adora's face, barely suppressing a smirk as she turned around to look over her shoulder to confirm her suspicions. Sure enough, Bow and Glimmer were standing by the hole in the wall where the door used to be, wearing a look that could only be described as utter mortification. Well, Glimmer looked more disturbed of the two, since Bow had respectfully averted his gaze elsewhere to offer them a minor amount of privacy.

"Well, *hey* there, Sparkles. Enjoying the show?" Catra casually asked, her quip ending in a burst of laughter when Adora began blushing herself into oblivion, smacking the feline's thigh in silent protest. "*Catra!*" she chided in a hushed whisper, prompting the

hybrid to turn her attention back to her mate, her grin the definition of insufferable.

"*What*? Someone had to break the ice otherwise they'd just keep standing there all wide-eyed and slack-jawed." Catra defended herself, rolling off of the blonde as her back arched in a lazy stretch. Adora let out a low gasp when she acknowledged the mess Catra had left on her leg, the majority of her release seeping into the fabric of her leggings. Catra noticed her dilemma, her grin shifting to apologetic.

"Don't fret, princess. I'll clean you up as soon as these two finally scram." Catra promised, licking her chops to cement her crude point even further. Glimmer shuddered in disgust, momentarily looking nauseous before her face settled into a subdued glare.

"She won't be the only thing in here you're cleaning up." Glimmer declared, angrily pointing to the splintered door littering the floor, looking about two breaths away from fuming. "*This*? *This* right here? Ten pounds of nope in a five-pound bag. I know you're making up for lost time but that *doesn't* mean you need to inflict property damage in the process."

"Hate to break it to you, Sparkles. But Blondie's the one who broke the doo-" Catra's sentence ended when the queen shushed her, covering her ears while glaring daggers at them both.

"I don't care *who* did it. *Fix* it. Understood?" Glimmer sternly ordered, ignoring the eye roll the feline served her. Catra let out an animated sigh, muttering a sarcastic "*Yes, mother*." before

Glimmer grabbed onto Bow, teleporting them out of the area. As soon as they were gone Catra lost it to her fit of laughter, bleary eyes shedding tears as the giggles rolled through her. Adora, whose face was now hiding her shame into the pillow, let out a defeated sigh. She lifted her head once the coast was clear, glancing over at the hybrid who was now snickering more than she was breathing. Pushing all that shame aside, Adora managed a half of a smile.

"I'm glad one of us is amused.." she half-heartedly mumbled, rising to her feet as she assessed the damage. Closing her eyes, she drew her hand forward, calling upon her magic. Catra's brows raised to an impressed look when all the broken shards of the door began to float back into place, reassembling themselves before her very eyes. By the time she was finished the door looked as good as new, as if She-Ra's gigantic boot hadn't disturbed it at all.

"Well, that solves *one* problem." Adora announced, engaging the lock as an extra precaution. Catra was sprawled out on the bed by now, patting the empty spot beside her as a silent invitation to join her. As embarrassed as she was, the princess couldn't refuse an offer like that, her anxious expression softening to a smile as she moved to join the feline. They both ended up on their sides, foreheads propped against one another.

"And what's the other problem then?" Catra wondered out loud, moving down south to fetch Adora's hand, twining their fingers together.

"Figuring out how I'm supposed to be able to look either of them in the eye again." Adora answered with a chuckle, a warmth

growing in her chest when Catra slowly blinked at her, another feline trait that wordlessly conveyed the depth of their connection with each other.

"I'm sure you'll figure it out, princess. And besides, you *won't* have to do it alone." Catra reminded her, the magicat mewling approvingly when Adora went to tentatively scratch that one sweet spot just below the square of her jaw, the rumble of her contented purring drowning out any silence in the room.

"Promise?" Adora asked with a smile, despite already knowing her answer. Catra answered with a gentle press of her lips, drinking in the scent of her childhood friend and newly acquired mate.

"I promise."

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